

TAB 4



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-235-23/24, **Version:** 1

Project Approval for the 49th Street Elementary School Major Modernization Project

April 9, 2024

Facilities Services Division

Action Proposed:

Approve the proposed 49th Street Elementary School Major Modernization Project (Project). The current Project budget is \$86,300,000.

Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of a Negative Declaration (ND). Pursuant to the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Guidelines, and to permit construction activities to commence at a later date, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board adopts the ND prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project.

Background:

On October 12, 2021, the Board approved project definition for the due diligence, planning, and feasibility activities necessary to propose scope recommendations, budget, and schedule for the proposed Project. Subsequently, on November 15, 2022, the Board approved the project definition for the proposed Project to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed Project.

The proposed Project is located on a 5.73-acre school campus at 750 East 49th Street within the South Park neighborhood in the City of Los Angeles (Board District 7, Region East). Construction of the 49th Street Elementary School (School) was completed in the early 1910s, and the School was dedicated in 1914. All existing buildings were constructed between 1923 and 1969. As of the 2023-2024 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review, the School served approximately 520 students in Universal Transitional Kindergarten through 5th grade.

The proposed Project will construct new facilities, including a one-story Kindergarten Classroom Building with four classrooms and associated support spaces; a one-story Multipurpose Room/Food Services/Library Building; a new lunch shelter, two shade structures; and new covered walkways. The proposed Project also includes minor interior improvements in existing buildings, converting the existing library and one classroom into administrative workrooms, exterior painting for all remaining buildings and structures at the School, and infrastructure upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act. The proposed Project will maintain the School's current capacity and total number of classrooms (43 classrooms).

The proposed Project includes the demolition of three permanent buildings (West Classroom Building, Auditorium, and Cafeteria), the lunch pavilion, and removal of three sheltered corridors.

The proposed Project will provide a minimum of 51 parking spaces and relocate the existing staff and visitor parking lots to the southwestern portion of the School along East 50th Street. A temporary fully electric interim relocatable kitchen/scramble building, and one interim relocatable restroom building will be installed to allow the School to remain operational and minimize impact during construction.

The proposed Project also includes utility upgrades; new playgrounds including play equipment/furnishings, striping, natural grass fields with irrigation, solar reflective coating, two play structures; new outdoor learning environments; a new parking lot with photovoltaic panels; landscaping and irrigation; hardscaping; installation of a new trash enclosure, service yard, loading zone, transformer yard; fencing, gates, and site furnishings.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken in the future once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction activities related to the construction of new buildings is anticipated to begin in the first quarter of 2026, and site/utility/interim housing activities may begin in advance of this work, in an earlier phase. Construction is anticipated to be completed in the third quarter of 2029.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of the staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with aging, deteriorating, and outdated buildings and grounds. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it adopted the project definition. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$86,300,000. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds targeted in the SUP for major modernizations, upgrades, and reconfigurations to school campuses.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will help ensure that the students attending the School are provided with safe and updated facilities that support learning.

Equity Impact:

The intent of the major modernization project is to address buildings and grounds that pose a safety concern and have the greatest need for upgrades with emphasis placed on seismic safety, reducing Los Angeles Unified's reliance on relocatable buildings, and addressing the most critical/severe physical conditions. While the Project is extensive in nature, less critical items may not be addressed. This approach allows the District to

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reach more schools with the limited funding available.

Issues and Analysis:

Environmental - OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of a ND. The ND was circulated for a 30-day public review period from November 8, 2023, to December 8, 2023. The analysis documented in the IS/ND found that the proposed Project would not result in significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must adopt the ND and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

Attachments:

None.

Informatives:

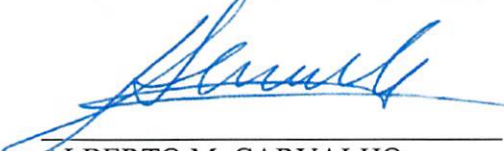
None.

Submitted:

03/12/24

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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